Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Cartref Care Home Ltd

Cartref Care Home, Henllan, Llandysul, SA44 5TD

01559371293

The inspection visit took place on 10/08/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	CARTREF CARE HOME LTD
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care
Registered places:	36
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Requires Improvement
Care & Support	Requires Significant Improvement
Environment	Requires Significant Improvement
Leadership & Management	Requires Significant Improvement

Summary:

Cartref Care Home is a service located in the village of Henllan, near Newcastle Emlyn, providing care for up to 36 adults. The service supports older people, including people living with dementia, and promotes Welsh language and culture.

Well-being requires improvement. People are generally positive about the care and support they receive and staff know people well. However, there is limited evidence people and their representatives are consistently involved in planning and reviewing of their care and support. Care records do not always reflect people's preferences, wishes and personal outcomes.

Care and Support requires significant improvement**.** Concerns exist regarding care planning, risk assessment and the oversight of care delivery. Care records do not consistently provide assurance people's needs are accurately assessed, planned for and reviewed. Concerns relating to medication management further reduce assurance that people consistently receive safe and effective care.

The Environment requires significant improvement**.** People do not consistently benefit from an environment where risks are identified and reduced. There is insufficient assurance that health and

safety arrangements, maintenance processes and environmental oversight are effective in identifying concerns and ensuring timely action is taken to mitigate risk.

Leadership and Management requires significant improvement**.** Governance and oversight arrangements have not been sufficiently effective in identifying and addressing concerns, managing risk and driving sustained improvement across the service.

As a result of these concerns Priority Action Notices have been issued.

There has been a change in the management of the service since our last inspection. The new manager is addressing where improvements can be made. New management arrangements are having a positive impact.

Findings:

Well-being — Requires Improvement

People are generally positive about the care and support they receive and are treated with dignity and respect. Positive interactions take place between staff and people living at the home and people appear comfortable within their surroundings. People have access to healthcare services when required and there is evidence of engagement with external professionals to support their health and well-being. People are supported to maintain important relationships with family and friends and Welsh language and culture continue to be promoted within the service.

People do not consistently experience care and support that is planned and reviewed in a way that reflects their individual wishes, preferences and personal outcomes. Care records do not always contain sufficient person-centred information. There is limited evidence that people and their representatives are routinely involved in the development and review of personal plans. "This is Me" documentation was not consistently completed, and resident meetings were not taking place. This limits opportunities for people to formally share their views and influence the care and support they receive.

Opportunities for consultation and engagement are not consistently evident, and records do not always demonstrate how people's views influence the development of the service. Whilst activities are available within the home, there is limited evidence they are consistently planned around individuals' interests, preferences and outcomes. People are not routinely supported to access opportunities within the wider community. Information regarding advocacy and complaints was not readily available, reducing assurance that people are fully supported to express their views, exercise choice and understand how to raise concerns. People benefit from respectful relationships, support to maintain important connections and access to healthcare services when required. Improvements are needed to ensure people are consistently involved in decisions about their care and support and that records and practices fully reflect their needs, preferences and desired outcomes. As a result, outcomes for people require improvement and we expect the provider to make improvements.

Care & Support

Requires Significant Improvement

People are supported by caring staff who treat them with dignity and respect. Positive interactions take place between staff and people living at the home and healthcare professionals are involved in supporting people's health and well-being. The newly appointed manager has recognised areas requiring improvement and has started reviewing care documentation and strengthening care planning arrangements.

People do not consistently receive care and support that is planned, delivered and reviewed in accordance with their needs and personal outcomes. Personal plans do not always provide accurate and person-centred guidance for staff and some records lacked sufficient information regarding people's preferences, routines, outcomes and support needs. This reduces assurance that care is consistently delivered in accordance with people's individual needs and wishes.

Risk management arrangements are not consistently effective. Risk assessments are not always reviewed following incidents or changes in need and do not consistently reflect people's current circumstances. Records do not always demonstrate how incidents, accidents and falls are evaluated or how learning has informed future care and support arrangements.

Limited evidence was available to demonstrate people and, where appropriate, their representatives are routinely involved in developing and reviewing personal plans. “This is Me” documentation was not consistently available to support staff understanding of people's preferences, life histories and what matters to them. Records did not consistently demonstrate how people and their representatives were involved in decisions about their care and support.

Safeguarding, medication management and falls management arrangements do not consistently provide assurance that risks are recognised, reviewed and managed effectively. Records and oversight arrangements did not always demonstrate appropriate analysis of incidents, learning from events or timely escalation to other parties where required. Medication audits and competency assessments had not effectively identified or addressed concerns.

The provider does not consistently demonstrate that staff receive appropriate training, supervision and support. Training and workforce records did not provide sufficient assurance that staff had completed relevant training or that all workers requiring registration with Social Care Wales had completed registration.

Whilst improvements have commenced, significant shortcomings remain in relation to care planning, risk management, medication management, safeguarding and workforce oversight. Improvements have not yet become embedded in practice or resulted in sustained positive outcomes for people. People cannot be assured that care and support is consistently safe, effective and person-centred. Outcomes for people require significant improvement and we have therefore

issued a priority action notice. The provider must take immediate action to address this issue.

Environment

Requires Significant Improvement

People live in a home that is welcoming, clean and tidy, and bedrooms are personalised to reflect individual preferences. Suitable equipment is available to support people's assessed needs and communal areas provide opportunities for people to spend time with others. Food hygiene arrangements remain “Very Good” and necessary equipment servicing arrangements are largely in place. The provider has also taken action to strengthen security arrangements at the main entrance and plans are in place for further improvements.

People do not consistently benefit from an environment where risks are effectively identified, monitored and reduced. Environmental and health and safety oversight arrangements do not provide sufficient assurances that concerns are identified promptly and addressed within appropriate timescales. Records relating to environmental checks, maintenance and monitoring processes did not consistently demonstrate effective oversight of risks.

The provider could not consistently demonstrate that actions arising from health and safety, maintenance and environmental monitoring processes had been completed and reviewed. This reduces assurance that risks to people's safety and well-being are effectively managed. There was also limited evidence of routine environmental monitoring checks, including some maintenance and safety records, not being completed and available for review.

Environmental hazards were identified throughout the home. Flooring and carpeting in some areas of the service were worn and in need of replacement and presented avoidable trip hazards for people living at the home. Other areas of the environment required repair, maintenance and redecoration. These issues are of particular significance given the number of people living with dementia and those with mobility difficulties.

Arrangements relating to the security of the front entrance door did not provide assurance that identified risks are being effectively managed. Previous concerns regarding security arrangements resulted in reliance on a doorbell system to alert staff when the entrance was used. The provider has subsequently strengthened arrangements by ensuring the door remains locked and has plans in place to install an electronic keypad entry system. These actions are welcomed and demonstrate recognition that additional measures are required to reduce risk.

The provider is not able to consistently demonstrate that effective systems are in place to identify environmental concerns, assess risk and ensure timely action is taken. This reduces assurance that people are protected from avoidable harm within their living environment and that the environment consistently supports their safety and well-being. As a result, outcomes for people require significant improvement and we have therefore issued a priority action notice. The provider

must take immediate action to address this issue.

Leadership & Management

Requires Significant Improvement

The newly appointed manager demonstrates a good understanding of the improvements required within the service and has already started to implement changes in key areas. The manager is open to feedback, responsive to concerns raised and committed to improving outcomes for people living at the home. Positive working relationships have been established with external professionals and partner agencies.

Governance and oversight arrangements do not consistently provide assurance the service is operating safely and in accordance with regulatory requirements. Quality assurance systems have not been effective in identifying, monitoring and addressing concerns relating to care planning, risk management, medication management, safeguarding and environmental safety. Several issues identified during the inspection had not been recognised through existing audits or provider oversight arrangements.

The provider does not consistently demonstrate effective quality assurance systems are in place to monitor the quality and safety of the service. Audits had failed to identify concerns within care records, medication administration processes and environmental risk management. This reduces assurance that people benefit from a service which is regularly monitored and improved.

Records relating to staff supervision, appraisal and support are not consistently available. Training records were not available to provide assurance that staff had completed training relevant to their roles and responsibilities, including training required to support people safely and effectively. Inspectors were not assured that all care workers required to be registered with Social Care Wales had completed registration. Records did not provide sufficient assurance that appropriate DBS checks had been completed and maintained in line with regulatory requirements. These shortfalls reduce assurance that staff are appropriately supported, monitored and equipped to meet people's needs safely and effectively.

The Responsible Individual could not demonstrate that oversight arrangements were sufficiently robust to identify concerns, monitor compliance and drive improvement across the service. Regulatory responsibilities had not been consistently met and provider oversight had not identified or addressed several of the concerns found during the inspection. This reduces assurance that effective arrangements are in place to monitor the quality and safety of the service and ensure compliance with regulations.

Whilst improvements have commenced, they remain at an early stage and have not yet become embedded in practice. Significant shortcomings remain in relation to governance, oversight, workforce development and quality assurance arrangements. As a result, people cannot be

assured that the service is consistently subject to effective leadership, management and oversight. Leadership and Management requires significant improvement. As a result of the concerns, outcomes for people require significant improvement and we have therefore issued a priority action notice. The provider must take immediate action to address this issue.

There has been a change in the management of the service since our last inspection. The new manager is addressing where improvements can be made. New management arrangements are having a positive impact.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

The table(s) below show the area(s) for priority action and/or those for improvement we have identified.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

Summary of areas for Priority Action	Date identified
The provider must ensure people receive safe, person-centred care that reflects their assessed needs, risks and outcomes. Care planning, risk management, medication and safeguarding systems must be effective, and staff must have the skills and competence required to meet people's needs safely.	10/08/26
The provider must ensure health and safety risks are identified, assessed and managed effectively, with appropriate oversight and governance arrangements to ensure environmental, fire and electrical safety risks are addressed promptly and people are protected from avoidable harm.	10/08/26
The Responsible Individual must demonstrate effective oversight of the service through robust governance and quality assurance arrangements that identify, monitor and address risks, support compliance with regulatory requirements and ensure people receive safe, high-quality care.	10/08/26

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

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